

Weekly Breaking Of Bread

prc-weekly-breaking-of-bread

Sacraments · Lord's Supper · practice · minority_lineages · brethren distinctive

DISPUTED

score 0.787
confidence medium

Statement under examination

The Lord's Supper (breaking of bread) is observed weekly on the Lord's Day as the central act of corporate worship.

In plain language

The claim has three parts that have to be tested separately: that the breaking of bread happens weekly, that it happens on the Lord's day (the first day of the week), and that it is the central act of the gathering. The word data supports the first-day part most clearly. In Acts 20:7 the believers met on the first day of the week, 'on the first day of the week' (en de te mia ton sabbaton), for the stated purpose of breaking bread, 'to break bread' (klasai arton), and that exact first-day idiom recurs in seven verses across the New Testament, so it is a stable expression. In Acts 2:42 'the breaking of the bread' is something the early believers kept doing, a habit, listed beside teaching, fellowship, and prayers and joined to them simply by the word 'and', with none ranked above the rest. The trouble is the words 'weekly' and 'central'. No term in these verses fixes a once a week interval. The one frequency word that actually appears is 'as often as' (hosakis) in 1 Corinthians 11:25 and 26, 'do this as often as you drink it', and its only other use, in Revelation 11:6, also means 'as often as they wish', so it is open ended, not a calendar. Acts 2:46 even reports breaking bread day by day and house to house, a different rhythm in the same record, and 1 Corinthians 16:2 attaches the very same first-day phrase to setting aside a collection rather than to the meal. The phrase 'Lord's day' leans on the word 'belonging to the Lord' (kyriakos), which appears only twice, once of 'the Lord's supper' (kyriakon deipnon) and once of 'the Lord's day', and the two never sit in the same verse, so the wording never fuses the meal to a named day. So a first-day breaking of bread is well attested, but the specific quantity 'weekly' and the specific status 'central' are inferences readers add, not labels the wording supplies, which is why the verdict here is disputed rather than a plain yes or no.

Word dictionary

Every Hebrew and Greek word this study leans on, in everyday terms. Shaded rows are the anchor words the verdict rests on.

Strong	Word	Sounds like	Plain meaning	Times in Bible
G0364	ἀνάμνησις	anamnesis	remembrance	4
G0740	ἄρτος	artos	bread	99
G0891	ἄχρι	achri	until	
G1172	δειπνέω	deipneō	to dine	
G1173	δεῖπνον	deipnon	dinner	16
G1322	διδασχὴ	didache	teaching	30
G1520	εἷς	heis	one	355
G2800	κλάσις	klasis	breaking	2
G2806	κλάω	klao	to break	15
G2960	κυριακός	kyriakos	the Lord's	2

G2983	λαμβάνω	lambanō	to take	
G3740	ὅσάκις	hosakis	whenever	3
G3860	παράδιδωμι	paradidōmi	to deliver	
G4095	πίνω	pinō	to drink	
G4221	ποτήριον	potērion	cup	
G4342	προσκαρτερέω	proskartereo	to continue in/with	10
G4521	σάββατον	sabbaton	Sabbath	68
G5315	φαγεῖν	phagein	to eat	

Plain meanings: STEP Bible brief lexicons TBESH (Hebrew) and TBESG (Greek), CC BY 4.0. Counts are occurrences across the 66-book canon.

Verdict rationale

Variant-robust: True · Pan-canonical: False

The lexical data attests a first-day gathering whose stated purpose was to break bread (Acts 20:7, 'on the first day of the week' (en de te mia ton sabbaton), the 'one' (heis) plus 'sabbath/week' (sabbaton) idiom, 'to break bread' (klasai arton)), and a habitual devotion to the breaking of the bread (Acts 2:42, 'the breaking of the bread' (te klasei tou artou), the noun 'breaking' (klasis) G2800, under the durative (ongoing, sustained) verb 'devoted themselves to' (proskartereo) G4342). But no term in the cited texts encodes a commanded weekly frequency or ranks the act above the others in the series. The only explicit frequency word in the institution texts is 'as often as' (hosakis) (G3740), which occurs three times in the canon and means 'as often as', grammatically indefinite (not specifying any fixed interval), confirmed by its sole other use in Revelation 11:6 ('as often as they desire' (hosakis ean thelesosin)). The first-day idiom is canonically stable across seven verses, yet 'breaking of bread' is joined to it only once (Acts 20:7), while the same idiom carries a collection in 1 Corinthians 16:2 and resurrection narrative elsewhere, and the word for 'the Lord's' ('belonging to the Lord' (kyriakos) G2960) never co-occurs in a verse with the breaking of bread. The proposition is therefore lexically defensible by inference but materially contested at the level of frequency and primacy, so the verdict is disputed.

Scripture

Acts.20.7 · for · genre: narrative

Key terms. G2806 κλάω, G0740 ἄρτος, G1520 εἶς, G4521 σάββατον

Force. The phrase 'on the first day of the week' (en de te mia ton sabbaton) locates a gathering whose stated purpose was 'to break bread' (klasai arton), with the verb 'to break' (klao) (G2806). The construction 'one' (heis) plus 'sabbath/week' (sabbaton) is the standard idiom for the first day, and a canon query shows it recurring stably in seven first-day verses. The clause supplies a first-day datum but contains no adverb of recurrence and no word ranking the meal above the accompanying preaching, 'he discoursed/reasoned with them' (dielegeto). It is one reported occasion narrated in past tense (the same gathering continues in Acts 20:11, where 'break' (klao) recurs after midnight), not a stated rule of frequency.

Acts.2.42 · for · genre: narrative

Key terms. G2800 κλάσις, G4342 προσκατερέω, G1322 διδαχή

Force. 'The breaking of the bread' is 'the breaking of the bread' (te klasei tou artou), where the head noun is 'breaking' (klasis) (G2800), a near-hapax (a word occurring only twice in the entire Bible) appearing only here and in Luke 24:35, not the verb 'to break' (klaō). It is listed as one of four matters to which the believers were continually devoted, the participle 'devoting themselves' (proskarterountes) (G4342) carrying durative (ongoing, sustained) force, the same verb that in Acts 2:46 governs the daily breaking. The list places 'breaking of bread' in series with 'the apostles' teaching' (didache) (G1322), 'the fellowship', and 'the prayers', joined by 'and' (kai), with no syntactic subordination (grammatical placement under) of the others to it. The durative verb supports habitual practice but encodes neither a fixed weekly interval nor a designated day.

1Cor.11.20 · neutral · genre: epistle

Key terms. G2960 κυριακός, G1173 δεῖπνον

Force. Paul writes 'when you come together in one place' (synerchomenon oun hymon epi to auto), framing the assembly as the setting for 'the Lord's supper' (kyriakon deipnon). The adjective 'belonging to the Lord' (kyriakos) (G2960) occurs only twice in the canon, here of 'the Lord's supper' and in Revelation 1:10 of 'the Lord's day', and the two never share a verse, so the wording does not itself fuse the meal to a named day. The participle of 'coming together' marks a recurring corporate gathering, but it does not state how often, and the censure 'it is not' (ouk estin) addresses abuse rather than fixing frequency.

1Cor.11.25 · complicates · genre: epistle

Key terms. G3740 ὡσάκις, G0364 ἀνάμνησις, G4221 ποτήριον

Force. The institution command 'do this, as often as you drink' (touto poieite, hosakis ean pinete) sets the explicit frequency term of the passage as 'as often as' (hosakis) (G3740) with 'if/whenever' (ean), an indefinite frequency conjunction meaning 'as often as' without specifying an interval. 'As often as' (hosakis) occurs only three times in the canon, and its sole non-Pauline use, Revelation 11:6 'as often as they desire' (hosakis ean thelesosin), confirms the indefinite (not fixing any interval) open-ended sense. The remembrance clause 'for the remembrance of me' (eis ten emen anamnesin) ('remembrance' (anamnesis) G0364) gives the meal's purpose, not its calendar. This is the load-bearing frequency word in the corpus and it is grammatically open-ended.

1Cor.11.26 · complicates · genre: epistle

Key terms. G3740 ὡσάκις, G0891 ἄχρι, G0740 ἄρτος

Force. 'For as often as you eat this bread' (hosakis gar ean esthiete ton artion touton) repeats the indefinite frequency idiom and bounds the practice temporally by 'until he comes' (achri hou elthe), an eschatological terminus (end-point relating to the last things) rather than a weekly cadence. The repetition of 'as often as' (hosakis) confirms that the canon marks the meal as recurring and ongoing while leaving its interval unspecified.

1Cor.16.2 · neutral · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1520 εἶς, G4521 σάββατον

Force. 'On the first day of every week' (kata mian sabbatou) uses the same 'one' (heis) plus 'sabbath/week' (sabbaton) idiom as Acts 20:7 but attaches it to a different activity, the laying aside of a collection, 'let each one of you put aside, storing up' (par heauto titheto thesaurizon), with the noun 'collection' (logeia), a gathering of money. The 'according to' (kata) plus accusative (a grammatical case marking the direct object) here does carry a distributive (one-by-one, every) 'every week' sense, but it governs the setting aside of funds, not the breaking of bread. The verse shows the first-day idiom was a recognized rhythm yet was tied in the words to more than one practice, none of them ranked.

Cross references invoked

From	To	Source	Votes
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Acts.2.42	Acts.20.7	openbible	1
Acts.2.42	Acts.2.46	openbible	1
Acts.2.42	Luke.24.35	openbible	1
Acts.2.42	1Cor.10.16	openbible	1
Acts.2.42	Heb.10.25	openbible	1
Acts.20.7	Acts.20.9	tsk	1
1Cor.11.23	1Cor.15.3	tsk	1
1Cor.11.24	1Cor.5.7	tsk	1
1Cor.11.24	Exod.12.14	tsk	1

Complicating texts

1Cor.11.25 · addressed

The only explicit frequency word in the institution texts is 'as often as' (hosakis ean), a near-hapax (a word occurring only a handful of times in the entire Bible) of three canon uses whose indefinite (not fixing any specific interval) sense is fixed by Revelation 11:6, 'as often as they desire' (hosakis ean thelesosin). The canon therefore commands repetition without prescribing a weekly interval, so the weekly claim of the proposition cannot be drawn from the institution command itself and must rest on the narrative inference from Acts 20:7.

Acts.2.46 · addressed

Acts 2:46 reports breaking bread 'breaking bread' (klontes te arton) (the verb 'to break' (klao), G2806) 'from house to house' (kat oikon), and 'day by day' (kath hemeran), under the same durative (ongoing, sustained) verb 'devoted themselves to' (proskartereo) that governs Acts 2:42. A daily, house-based pattern stands in tension with a fixed once-weekly Lord's-Day pattern, showing that the lexical record describes more than one cadence of breaking bread and does not lock the practice to a single weekly observance.

Acts.20.7 · addressed

The first-day reference is a single narrative occasion describing what the gathered believers did, not a normative frequency rule. Of the seven verses where the first-day idiom 'one' (heis) plus 'sabbath/week' (sabbaton) occurs, only this one ties it to breaking bread, while 1 Corinthians 16:2 ties the same idiom to a collection. Narrative description of one event does not by itself establish a commanded weekly ordinance, so the weekly and central elements of the proposition are inferred rather than lexically stated.

1Cor.11.20 · addressed

The proposition uses the phrase 'Lord's Day', but the adjective 'belonging to the Lord' (kyriakos) occurs only twice in the canon, of 'the Lord's supper' here and of 'the Lord's day' in Revelation 1:10, and the two uses never share a verse. The words therefore do not lexically fuse the meal to a named day, so the conjunction of 'Lord's Day' and 'breaking of bread' is a synthesis the reader supplies, not a phrase the text states. This is noted rather than left unaddressed.

Concordance traversed

G2806, G2800, G0740, G3740, G0364, G1173, G1172, G4521, G1520, G2960, G4342, G1322, G2983, G3860, G4221, G5315, G4095

Variants

Verdict variant-sensitive: False · ECM status: ecm-shadow

A direct query of the lexical store returned zero variant units on the cited Acts and 1 Corinthians anchors, and these books are outside the ingested ECM apparatus (the critical edition of New Testament textual variants) window (3 John). The NA-style apparatus

(Nestle-Aland style critical edition footnotes) marks at Acts 20:7 ('our' (hemon)) and 1 Corinthians 11:24-26 affect pronouns and minor wording, not the presence of the first-day idiom, the breaking-of-bread phrase, or the 'as often as' (hosakis) frequency idiom, so the verdict holds across plausible readings.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. narrative_normativity, regulative_principle, command_only_normativity

analogia scripturae invoked

narrative-as-normative-precedent: affirms · Reading Acts 20:7 together with the habitual breaking of bread in Acts 2:42 as a settled apostolic precedent yields a regular first-day observance. On this lens the recurring first-day idiom ('one' (heis) plus 'sabbath/week' (sabbaton) across seven verses), the durative (ongoing, sustained) verb 'devoted themselves to' (proskartereo) of Acts 2:42, and the explicit first-day gathering of Acts 20:7 are taken as a pattern the church is meant to follow, so weekly first-day breaking of bread is affirmed as the apostolic shape of corporate worship.

command-only-normativity: denies · Restricting normativity to explicit command leaves only 'as often as' (hosakis ean), which is indefinite (not fixing any specific interval), and the institution command names a purpose ('remembrance' (anamnesis)) not a calendar. On this lens Acts 20:7 is one narrated occasion, Acts 2:46 attests a different daily cadence, and no word ranks the meal as the central act, so neither the weekly frequency nor the central-act ranking is lexically commanded and the proposition is not established.

frequency-and-primacy-underdetermined: disputed · Granting that the text attests both a first-day gathering for bread and a habitual practice, this lens holds that the specific quantifier 'weekly' and the priority claim 'central' are simply not lexicalized (not encoded by any specific word): 'as often as' (hosakis) is indefinite, the Acts 2:42 series is unranked, 'belonging to the Lord' (kyriakos) never joins the meal to a day, and the canon supplies two cadences (first-day in Acts 20:7, daily in Acts 2:46) that the words do not rank. The reading that fits the vocabulary most cautiously is that the proposition asks for precision the wording does not supply, hence disputed.

The split among the lenses is precisely why the verdict is disputed. The texts supply a first-day datum and a habitual practice, but the proposition's specific quantifier, 'weekly', and its priority claim, 'central act', are supplied by inference, not by a lexical marker (a specific word that encodes the claim). Each lens is internally coherent on the same word data; they differ on whether descriptive narrative and an unranked series may be read as a binding frequency rule.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: yes

Neutralized form. The breaking of bread is observed at corporate gatherings, and the texts attest its occurrence on the first day of the week and as a habitual practice; the questions of how frequently it is to be observed and what weight it holds relative to other elements of worship are examined rather than assumed.

The stem loads two contested claims into a single proposition: a fixed frequency, 'weekly', and a ranking, 'central act of corporate worship'. Neither the quantifier nor the priority ranking is encoded by a lexical term (a specific word in the original Greek) in the cited texts; the canon's explicit frequency word is the indefinite 'as often as' (hosakis), and the named-day word 'belonging to the Lord' (kyriakos) never co-occurs with the breaking of bread. The verdict is derived on the original stem, but the preloaded quantifier and ranking are why the result is disputed rather than a clean affirmation. Verdict unchanged from the prior file (disputed, medium); the enrichment corrected the Acts 2:42 head word to the noun 'breaking' (klasis) G2800, added the 'belonging to the Lord' (kyriakos) G2960 and 'devoted themselves to' (proskartereo) G4342 evidence, corrected the live occurrence counts for 'one' (heis) (355) and 'teaching' (didache) (30), and added 1 Corinthians 16:2 as the parallel first-day collection.

Citations

Type	Source	License	Redist.	Ref
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Acts.20.7
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G3740

lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G2800
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G2960
interlinear	STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Acts.2.42
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	Acts.2.42
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	Acts.20.7

License audit

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Source	License	Redistribute
MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes
STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes
STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes
OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes
TSK	public_domain	yes

Flags

lexically-disputed · ecm-shadow · cross-tradition-divergent